Fabian Eckert

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Fields

International Trade, Macroeconomics, Spatial Economics, and Urban Economics

Employment

SIEPR, Stanford University
Visiting Assistant Professor — September 2026 - May 2027

University of California, San Diego
Assistant Professor (on leave AY 26/27) — 2020-

Other Appointments

Journal of International Economics
Associate Editor — 2023-

Prosperity and Globalization Lab, University of California, San Diego
Partner — 2023-

Center for Commerce and Diplomacy, University of California, San Diego
Faculty Affiliate — 2020-

Past Positions

Princeton University
IES Postdoctoral Associate — 2019-2020

Visits

Kiel Institute for the World Economy
Visiting Scholar — Summer 2024

Becker Friedman Institute, University of Chicago
Visiting Scholar — December 2022

NYU Economics Department
Visiting Scholar — Fall 2022

Opportunity and Inclusive Growth Institute, Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis
Visiting Scholar — July, August 2019

Education

Yale University
Doctor of Philosophy, Department of Economics (with Distinction) — 2019
Master of Philosophy, Department of Economics (with Distinction) — 2016
Master of Arts, Department of Economics — 2015
Advisors: Costas Arkolakis, Giuseppe Moscarini, Samuel Kortum, Michael Peters

University College London
Bachelor of Science in Economics (with First Class Honours and Dean's List) — 2013

Publications

Combinatorial Discrete Choice 2026
Joint with Costas Arkolakis and Rowan Shi
NBER Working Paper #31877
American Economic Review (forthcoming)

The Early County Business Pattern Files: 1946-1974 2026
Joint with Ka-leung Lam, Atif Mian, Karsten Muller, Rafael Schwalb, and Amir Sufi
NBER Working Paper #30578
Economics Letters (accepted)

Sprouting Cities: How Rural America Industrialized 2023
Joint with John Juneau and Michael Peters
AEA Papers and Proceedings, Volume 113, May 2023, pp.87-92

The Return to Big City Experience: Evidence from Refugees in Denmark 2022
Joint with Mads Hejlesen and Conor Walsh
Journal of Urban Economics, Volume 130, July 2022, 103454

The Geography of Remote Work 2022
Joint with Lukas Althoff, Sharat Ganapati and Conor Walsh
Regional Science and Urban Economics, Volume 93, March 2022, 103770

Under Revision

Urban-Biased Growth: A Macroeconomic Analysis 2025
Joint with Sharat Ganapati and Conor Walsh
NBER Working Paper #30515
Journal of Political Economy

Spatial Structural Change 2025
Joint with Michael Peters
NBER Working Paper #30489
Review of Economic Studies

The Geography of Opportunity 2024
Joint with Tatjana Kleineberg
Journal of Political Economy

Working Papers

More Roads or Public Transit? Insights from Measuring City-Center Accessibility *(submitted)* 2023
Joint with Lucas Conwell and Mushfiq Ahmed Mobarak
NBER Working Paper #30877

Growing Apart: Tradable Services and the Fragmentation of the U.S. Economy 2019

Work in Progress

Housing as a Growth Bottleneck
Joint with Shane Nordquist and Fabian Trottner

Superstar ZIP Codes
Joint with Camilo Acosta and Jack Liang

Shorter Papers

A Method to Construct Geographical Crosswalks with an Application to US Counties since 1790 2026
Joint with Andrés Gvirtz, Jack Liang, and Michael Peters
Updated November 2026; earlier version: NBER Working Paper #26770 (2020)

Imputing Missing Values in the US Census Bureau's County Business Patterns 2021
Joint with Teresa C. Fort, Peter K. Schott, and Natalie J. Yang
NBER Working Paper #26632

Awards, Fellowships

UCSD Economics Teaching Award for Graduate Teaching	2024
The Society of Hellman Fellows	2024
Yale University George Trimis Dissertation Prize	2019
UAE Student Best Paper Runner Up ("Return to Big City Experience")	2018
University Dissertation Fellowship, Yale University	2018
Raymond Powell Prize for Outstanding Graduate Teaching	2017
Samuel K. Bushnell Fellow, Yale University	2017
Cowles Foundation Carl Arvid Anderson Prize Fellowship	2015-2016
Yale University, 2015 John Y. Campbell Fellowship	2014-2016
Yale University Doctoral Fellowship	2013-2018
University College London, Dean's List Award	2013
German National Scholarship Foundation	2011-2016
Bavarian Government Max Weber Scholarship (declined)	2010
German Physical Society (Outstanding Baccalaureate in Physics)	2010

Teaching Experience

Instructor, Cities, Innovation, and Inequality (Undergrad), UCSD	Spring 2021-2026
Instructor, Spatial Economics (PhD), UCSD	Spring 2021-2026
Instructor, Third-Year Paper (PhD), UCSD	2024-2026
Teaching Assistant, Introductory Macroeconomics, Prof. Aleh Tsyvinski, Yale University	2019
Teaching Assistant, Graduate Macroeconomics, Prof. Giuseppe Moscarini, Yale University	2017
Teaching Assistant, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Prof. Tony Smith, Yale University	2016
Herbert Scarf Undergraduate Research Program Instructor, Yale University	2016
Teaching Assistant, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Prof. Michael Peters, Yale University	2015
Economics PhD Math Camp, Prof. Truman Bewley, Yale University	2014

Professional Activities

Seminars/Presentations: *upcoming

2026: CREI Barcelona, SED Athens, HEC Paris, SF Fed, Claremont McKenna, West Coast Spatial Workshop at Stanford, Pizzanomics Einaudi Institute

2025: UEA Berlin, Arizona State University, LMU Munich, *Atlanta FED, *SED Meeting Copenhagen, TU Dortmund

2024: Philadelphia FED, SED Meeting Barcelona, Princeton-Chicago Spatial Conference, BSE Summer Forum Barcelona, NBER SI EFG, EEA Rotterdam, NYU Trade Day, AEA Annual Meeting, University of Warwick, Rotman School of Management, UBC, UEA Copenhagen, UEA Washington DC, Sciences Po Urban Workshop

2023: AEA Annual Meeting New Orleans, HKU Business School, The University of Hong Kong, Princeton Spatial Workshop, NBER SI Urban, Census Bureau, UC Davis, NBER ITI Fall Meeting

2022: AEA Annual Meeting, SED 2022, West Coast Spatial Workshop, Stanford Cities, Housing, and Society Student Research Group, NY FED, UC Irvine, UCLA Trade Day, University of Washington, Hitotsubashi University, Notre Dame

2021: AEA, Berkeley, Warwick, UEA Europe 2021, BU Trade Day, SAET Korea 2021, SED 2021, CREI, Virtual ITM

2020: CEPR Swiss Macro Workshop (Sils Maria), NYU Abu Dhabi, Berkeley O-Lab Urban Workshop, UCSD, University of Virginia, UEA 2020 Virtual, INSPER Brazil, USC Macro Days

2019: IZA/CREA Workshop: Exploring the Future of Work, Fudan University, HIT Shenzhen, Peking University, Tsinghua University, Princeton, NBER Cities, Labor Markets, and the Global Economy 2019, UEA Philadelphia, Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis, SED (St. Louis), Penn State New Faces in Trade Conference, Zoom Online Urban Seminar by Don Davis, University of Chicago, Chicago Booth, Tuck School of Business at Darmouth, University of Pennsylvania, University of California San Diego, University of Notre Dame, Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas, IIES Stockholm, CREI Barcelona, Penn State

2018: Yale Macro Lunch, Yale International Trade Prospectus Workshop

2013-2017: SED (Edinburgh), SAET (Faro), Yale Macro Lunch, Yale International Trade Prospectus Workshop

Discussions:

"Fighting for Resources: A Unified Growth Model of the Great Divergence" by LeFur and Wasmer
Urban Economics Association Conference Berlin 2025

"Is ZIP Code Destiny?" by Eshaghnia
Urban Economics Association Conference Copenhagen 2024

"The Life and Death of Great British Cities" by Heblich, Nagy, Trew, Zylberberg
FREIT North America Meeting at UCSD, San Diego 2022

"Global Warming and Labor Market Reallocation" by Cruz
Penn State New Faces 2022 2022

"Spatial Implications of Telecommuting" by Delventhal, Parkhomenko
Urban Economics Association Conference 2021, Zoom-based 2021

"Cities, Productivity, and Trade" by Garcia-Marin, Potlogea, Voigtlaender, Yang
AEA Meetings, Zoom-based 2021

"The Geography of Unemployment" by Bilal
Urban Economics Association Annual Conference 2019, Philadelphia 2019

"Global Sourcing and Assembly with Scale Economies" by Antràs, Fadeev, Fort, Tintelnot
Queen's Organizational Economics (QOE) Conference, Kingston, Ontario 2019

Organizer:

West Coast Spatial Workshop at Stanford (w/ G. Schubert, A. Parkhomenko, JC Serrato) Spring 2026

West Coast Spatial Workshop at USC (w/ G. Schubert, C. Tricaud, A. Parkhomenko) Spring 2025

West Coast Spatial Workshop at UC San Diego (w/ G. Schubert, M. Reher) Spring 2024

West Coast Spatial Workshop at UC Berkeley (w/ Cecile Gaubert, T. McQuade, N. Tsivanidis) Spring 2023

West Coast Spatial Workshop at UCLA (w/ G. Schubert, C. Tricaud, A. Parkhomenko) Spring 2022

PhD Student Workshop of the Urban Economics Association 2020 (w/ C.Balboni, D.Davis, K.Schmidheiny, D.Sturm, M.Turner) Summer 2020

Urban Economics Association Lectures in Urban Economics 2020 (w/ C.Balboni, D.Davis, K.Schmidheiny, D.Sturm, M.Turner) Summer 2020

Online Spatial and Urban Seminar (w/ C.Balboni, C.Gorback, C.Severen) Summer 2020

Quantitative Spatial Economics Junior Workshop (w/ C.Balboni) May, 2020

Yale Macroeconomics Breakfast (Initiator) Weekly, 2015-2017

Advising: (placement in parentheses)

Undergraduates at UCSD:
Gregory Boscaiu (UCSD Rady Business School), Evan Moore (Kyoto University), Jake DiCicco (Georgia Tech), Sehong Park (UCLA School of Law), Jack Rosetti (Columbia Pre-Doc), Henri Runge (Harvard Pre-Doc)

PhD Students at UCSD:
Carlos Goes (World Bank Group), Sabareesh Ramachandran (Indian School of Business, Hyderabad; postdoc at University of Chicago), Steven Brownstone (GiveWell), Ishani Chatterjee (IMF), Aakash Bhalothia (ongoing), Ida Grigoryeva (ongoing), Jordan Mosqueda (ongoing), John Juneau (ongoing), Renata Abbott Navarrete (ongoing), Vafa Behnam (ongoing), Harrison Mitchell (ongoing)

Referee for:
AEJ: Economic Policy
AEJ: Macroeconomics
American Economic Review
Canadian Journal of Economics
Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft
Econometrica
Economic Journal
Economic Theory
Economica
International Economic Review
Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization
Journal of Economic Geography
Journal of Economic Growth
Journal of Economic History
Journal of International Economics
Journal of Monetary Economics
Journal of Political Economy
Journal of Political Economy: Macroeconomics
Journal of the European Economic Association
Journal of Urban Economics
Labour Economics
Nature Cities
Quantitative Economics
Quarterly Journal of Economics
Regional Science and Urban Economics
Review of Economic Dynamics
Review of Economic Studies
Review of Economics and Statistics
Scandinavian Journal of Economics

Committees:
Scientific Committee Member for the 2026 Conference on Urban and Regional Economics (CURE), Columbia University
Program Committee for Society of Economic Dynamics Conference Copenhagen 2025
Program Committee for the 2024 Annual Congress of the European Economic Association
Program Committee Member for the 2023 Meetings of the Urban Economics Association
Program Committee Member for the 2022 FREIT Meetings North America
Program Committee Member for the 2021 Meetings of the Urban Economics Association
Scientific Committee Member for the 2020 PhD Student Workshop of the Urban Economics Association
Program Committee Member for the 2020 Meetings of the Urban Economics Association
Program Committee Member for the 2019 Meetings of the Urban Economics Association

Other

Languages:
German (native), English (fluent), French (fluent), Spanish (Basic)